More in common than you think

Six things these faiths share, each in its own words. The practices look alike; the reasons behind them belong to each faith.

	Hinduism	Buddhism	Judaism	Christianity	Islam	Sikhism
Treat others as you'd want to be treated	Don't do to others what you would find hurtful yourself. Mahabharata, Anushasana Parva (paraphrase)	Everyone fears harm. Seeing others as yourself, harm no one. Dhammapada 129 (paraphrase)	"What is hateful to you, do not do to your fellow." Hillel, Talmud, Shabbat 31a	"Whatsoever ye would that men should do to you, do ye even so to them." Matthew 7:12 (KJV)	None of you truly believes until he loves for his brother what he loves for himself. Forty Hadith of an-Nawawi, 13	No one is my enemy, and no one is a stranger. Guru Granth Sahib, Ang 1299 (paraphrase)
Give to people in need	**Dana**: a gift given freely, expecting nothing back. Bhagavad Gita 17.20	**Dana**: generosity, the first of the perfections a Buddhist cultivates. Buddhist teaching	**Tzedakah**: giving to the poor as a matter of justice. Jewish teaching	"I was an hungred, and ye gave me meat." Matthew 25:35 (KJV)	**Zakat**: giving a share of your wealth, one of the Five Pillars. Islamic teaching	**Vand chhakna**: share what you have. **Langar**: the free community kitchen. Sikh teaching
Light in the dark	**Diwali**: rows of lamps for light over darkness.	**Vesak**: lanterns for the Buddha's birth and awakening, in many countries.	**Hanukkah**: eight nights of lights.	**Advent and Christmas**: candles for Jesus, "the light of the world." John 8:12	"Allah is the Light of the heavens and the earth." Qur'an 24:35	**Bandi Chhor Divas**: lamps at the Golden Temple for a Guru's release.
Thanks before eating	Food is offered first, then shared as a blessing (**prasad**).	A short reflection or chant before the meal, in many traditions.	**HaMotzi**: the blessing over bread.	**Grace** before meals.	**Bismillah** before eating, **Alhamdulillah** after.	Food is shared in the **langar** after prayer (**Ardas**).
Welcome the stranger	"Atithi devo bhava": treat your guest as God. Taittiriya Upanishad 1.11.2	**Metta**: loving-kindness for all beings. Karaniya Metta Sutta	Abraham runs to welcome three strangers to his tent. Genesis 18	"Be not forgetful to entertain strangers." Hebrews 13:2 (KJV)	Whoever believes in Allah and the Last Day, let him honor his guest. Forty Hadith of an-Nawawi, 15	**Langar**: anyone, of any faith, sits on the floor and eats together.
Times of fasting	**Vrat**: fasts on holy days, such as during Navratri.	Lay precepts on observance days; monks and nuns don't eat after noon.	**Yom Kippur**: a full day's fast.	**Lent**: forty days of fasting and giving up.	**Ramadan**: fasting from dawn to sunset for a month.	A real difference: the Gurus taught that ritual fasting isn't needed.
And what's different	These faiths understand God differently: one God (Judaism, Christianity, Islam, Sikhism); one ultimate reality seen in many forms (for many Hindus); and no creator God at the center (Buddhism). Christians believe Jesus is the Son of God; Muslims honor him as a prophet; Jews don't see him as the Messiah. Each faith explains its own practices in its own way. Learning the differences with respect is part of learning what you share.					

Quotations marked KJV are from the King James Bible (public domain). "Paraphrase" marks our own plain wording of the cited text. Hadith wording is a common English rendering. To be confirmed by each faith's scholar (Keeper) before public use.